Robin Rowland

PhD Candidate
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Key skills

Data management • Statistical analysis (R) • Project coordination • Stakeholder engagement • Scientific communication

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, and strong statistical analysis skills in R.

Education

2023 - present **Doctor of Philosophy**, University of the Sunshine Coast
Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats
Anticipated completion: January 2026

2012 - 2016 **Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program), Animal Behaviour**, Eckerd College, USA

Relevant experience

2023 - present **PhD Researcher**, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD
• Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology
• Developed an open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database
• Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations, and state and local government, and communicate findings to stakeholders
• Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects (three undergraduate, three honours)

2024 - present **Student Scholar**, GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks
• Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners, and other specialists
• Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including the creation, cleaning, and management of a large citation database
• Contribute to the development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines as part of the Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working Group

2023 - present

Tutor, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD
ANM100 - Animal Ecology Field Course (×4)
• Deliver course content on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students during a field course on North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah)
• Demonstrate ecological field techniques, including transects, acoustic monitoring, and animal identification, across diverse terrains and adapt delivery to varied student abilities
ANM103 - Animal Form and Function (×4) | ENS222 - Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity & Ecology (×3)
• Instruct university students in laboratory techniques and scientific writing, moderate discussions, and mark assignments within short turnaround periods
• Lead student groups on annual vertebrate identification field trips

2017 - 2023

Outreach Coordinator, Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD
• Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies, and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information in a fast-paced environment
• Represented the company at academic conferences and communicated with the public and scientific community through emails, reports, and reviews

Aug 2019 - Dec 2022

Literature Database Manager & Website Editor, Wildlife Tourism Australia
• Sorted and standardised an existing literature database to improve accessibility, integrated an embedded Zotero library, and provided ongoing updates for new publications
• Maintained and updated website content to reflect information and updates from individual member sites

2016

Research Intern, Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA
• Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological, and parasite data on a range of mammalian and avian species
• Coordinated with other researchers to design novel experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects to internal and external stakeholders

2015

Research Intern, Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA
• Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphin individuals during weekly field surveys and assisted with database updates and maintenance
• After the internship concluded, worked remotely with the laboratory to complete a study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations

Service roles

2026

Bats in Buildings Working Group Member

2026

UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee

2023 - present

Treasurer, UniSC Ecological Society

2020 - 2024

Committee Member, Wildlife Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim

2019 - present

Wildlife Rescuer & Workshop Co-Lead, Bats Queensland

Grants and awards

2025

Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding (21,851), GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks
Co-investigator

2024

Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation (49,586), WIRES National Research Grant
Co-investigator

2023 - 2026 **Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland** (20,720), Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment
Lead Author

2023 **Radio Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats** (2,720), Holohil Transmitter Grant Program
Lead Author

2023 **Bat Roost Identification** (1,197), Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant
Lead Author

2021 **Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim** (49,000), Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants
Lead Author

2020 **Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers** (1,950), Logan EnviroGrants
Lead Author

2020 **ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building** (9,900), Logan EnviroGrants
Lead Author

Invited presentations

Aug-2026 **UniSC Ecological Society**
Introduction to Scientific Writing

Apr-2026 **GBatNet 'My Field for Dummies' Online Series**
Urban Bat Ecology

Oct-2025 **University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast**
Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours

Jul-2025 **UniSC Ecological Society**
Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations

Sep-2024 **UniSC Ecological Society**
Ecological Careers Workshop

Presentations and posters

Aug-2026 **Physiological Tools for Monitoring Urban Impacts at The Roost Level in Insectivorous Bats**
Talk - Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia

Dec-2025 **Stressed Out Bats: Developing Tools to Monitor Physiological Stress in Three Insectivorous Species**
Talk - Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia

Nov-2025 **Bats Are in The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models**
Talk - Ecological Society of Australia Conference, Australia

Aug-2025 **No One Size Fits All: Exploring Anthropogenic Roost Selection Across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland**
Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia

Aug-2025 **The System Works: Post-Release Survival of Rehabilitated Insectivorous Bats in Australia**
Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia

Jul-2025 **Home Is Where the Bats Are: Bats in Man-Made Structures in South East Queensland**
Talk - Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia

Oct-2024 **Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset**
Poster - North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico

Jul-2024 **Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset**
Poster - School of Science, Technology and Engineering Research Conference, Best Student Poster

Apr-2024 **From Rugs to Rocky Overhangs: Diverse Microclimates of Natural and Anthropogenic Bat Roosts in South East Queensland**
Talk - 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia

Apr-2024 **Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset**
Poster - Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia, Runner Up Student Poster

Nov-2023 **Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland**
Talk - Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia

Feb-2020 **The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare**
Talk - Wildlife Preservation Society Scenic Rim Corridors Workshop, Australia

Dec-2019 **The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination**
Talk - The Scenic Rim as an Environmentally-Sustainable International Wildlife Destination Workshop, Australia

Oct-2018 **Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positive Intentions Towards Glow-worms in the Wild?**
Talk - 5th National Wildlife Tourism Australia Conference, Australia

Apr-2016 **Do Common Bottlenose Dolphins That Interact with Humans Experience Greater Rates of Anthropogenic Injuries?**
Talk - Southeast and Mid-Atlantic Marine Mammal Symposium, USA, Best Undergraduate Oral Presentation

Apr-2015 **Can Mongoose Lemurs Recognize Individual Humans?**
Poster - 23rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition, USA

Science communication

Jan-2026 **ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland**, Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event

Jan-2026 **ABC Sunshine Coast Radio**, Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region

Aug-2024 **ABC Sunshine Coast, ABC Australia**, Commenting on Arson Incident on Mooloolah Valley Bat Colony

Jul-2024 **TalkECO Podcast**, Microbats, Chicken Nuggets, Stress and Wildlife Rescue!

Feb-2024 **Sunshine Coast News**, Study to Help Save Mini Bats That Fly Under the Radar

Feb-2024 **ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio**, Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis

Jul-2023 **Cosmos Magazine**, Little Forest Bats: Earth's Tiniest Heroes (Australian Mammal of the Year Profile)

Outreach

Mar-2026 **Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk**, Moreton Bay Council

Mar-2026	**Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant, Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit**, World Science Festival Brisbane
Nov-2025	**Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast, Maleny Bat Night**, Sunshine Coast Council
Oct-2025	**Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk**, Mooloolah River Landcare
Oct-2025	**Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ ('What's Brewing Behind the Dunes' Series)**, Coolum CoastCare
Nov-2024	**Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk**, UniSC Ecological Society
Oct-2024	**Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats, Maleny Bat Night**, Sunshine Coast Council
Oct-2024	**Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk**, Moreton Bay Council
Sep-2024	**Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader**, Springfield Lakes Nature Centre
May-2024	**Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think!**, Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD
Apr-2024	**Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series**, Brisbane Catchments Network
Oct-2023	**Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk**, Sunshine Coast BioBlitz

Skills and certifications

• Statistical analysis in R - linear modelling, mixed modelling, and spatial modelling with temporal and spatial autocorrelation (UQ R Course)

• Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F)

• Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015)

• Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation - CPR (HLTAID009)

Referees

Dr Clare Stawski (Primary Supervisor) - Senior Lecturer, University of the Sunshine Coast
cstawski@usc.edu.au |

Dr Alexis Levengood (Co-Supervisor and Field Course Leader) - Research Fellow, University of the Sunshine Coast
alevengo@usc.edu.au |